Lesson 8 — The Line We Share

Level: B1 (eighth step)

Theme: A shared connection, a class at eight, and an application abroad

Time: 6 sessions, 50–60 minutes each

Skills: Listening → Reading → Vocabulary → Grammar → Comprehension → Speaking → Writing

New in this lesson: the first and second conditional, the contracted 'd for would and had, the weak if-clause, and the present simple in time clauses. The passage stays at about 500 words for the third lesson running, and the question set is unchanged.

01 · Passage — The Line We Share

> How to do the listening. The same rule as every lesson so far: the student listens twice with no text, then reads. Audio files: `01-passage.mp3` first, then the other parts in order. Part `05-would-and-if.mp3` is new — the contracted 'd for would and had, and the weak if.

1.1 Before listening (2 minutes, Arabic is fine here)

1. If your connection failed in the middle of a class, what would you do?
2. What do you and your neighbours share, and what rules do you keep about it?
3. If you had one thing to make studying easier, what would you choose, and why?

1.4 Now read the passage

Passage: The Line We Share (516 words)

The connection comes into the street on one line, and everything else hangs off it. From a box on the third floor it goes up to an antenna on the roof, across to a second antenna on the roof opposite, and from there into four more flats. Seven families, one uplink.

[A] A mesh works like that: every point relays the signal on to the next, so a street can share one line instead of buying seven. No single family here could afford the line on its own, and together they can. It is cheap and it is clever, and it has one weakness that everybody who uses it learns in the first week. If the uplink fails, nothing after it works. The antennas are all fine. There is simply nothing to pass on.

Aya has a class at eight on Monday evenings — thirty students, a teacher in another city, and a slide deck that has to load. If the line is slow, the video stops and the voice survives, which she can work with. If the line goes down, the lesson is over for all thirty of them, because nobody has a second way in.

[B] So she prepares for both evenings at once. She downloads the slides on Sunday night, when the line is quiet and the latency is low, and she keeps the last four weeks of recordings on the laptop. If the class fails on Monday, she will read the slides and send her questions as messages. If it does not fail, she has lost nothing but twenty minutes of a quiet Sunday.

The families have rules, which is what makes a shared line reliable at all. Nobody sends anything large between seven and ten. If somebody has to, they say so first. If two people ignore that on the same evening, everyone knows within a minute, because the latency climbs and every class in the street begins to stutter.

[C] Aya is careful about what she says she would do with a faster line, because a wish is an easy thing to turn into an excuse. If she had a reliable fifty megabits, she says, she would stop planning around the connection and spend that hour on the work itself. She would also stop apologising at the start of every call.

[D] There is an application open on the laptop that she has been filling in for three weeks: a university in Spain, an exchange place with a small scholarship attached, and a language requirement she is four months away from meeting. If she is accepted, she will go for one semester. If she is not, she will apply again in the spring. Either way the English has to be finished, so the English gets done. That part is hers, and it is the one part the line cannot reach.

The tower on the roof is a length of pipe, two brackets and a cable tie, and a neighbour put it up in an afternoon. If it comes down in the next storm, they will put it up again. They have done it twice.

1.5 Read aloud

Read the passage aloud once and record it. Watch the tune of the conditional sentences: the if-clause rises, the main clause falls. Read three of them aloud twice, listening for the shape rather than the words.

02 · Listening questions

1.2 Listening — first time (no text)

L1. How does the connection reach the other building?

L2. What happens to the class if the line goes down?

L3. What does Aya do on Sunday night, and why?

L4. What is she applying for?

1.3 Listening — second time (no text)

Write two sentences you heard with if. Then write one thing Aya says she would do if she had a faster line, and one word you heard but did not understand.

03 · Vocabulary and Lesson 6 recall

2.1 Key words

#	WORD	TYPE	SIMPLE MEANING	ARABIC	EXAMPLE
1	uplink	noun	the one connection that joins a local network to the internet	الوصلة الصاعدة	Seven families, one uplink.
2	mesh	noun	a network in which every point passes the signal on to the next	شبكة متداخلة	A mesh lets a street share one line.
3	relay	verb	to pass a signal on to the next point	ينقل الإشارة	Every point relays the signal on to the next.
4	antenna	noun	the part that sends and receives a radio signal	هوائي	It goes up to an antenna on the roof.
5	signal	noun	the radio waves that carry data through the air	إشارة	There is simply no signal to pass on.
6	latency	noun	the delay between sending something and it arriving	زمن التأخير	She downloads the slides when the latency is low.
7	reliable	adjective	something you can depend on, because it works every time	موثوق	The rules are what make a shared line reliable.
8	tower	noun	a tall structure that holds an antenna up high	برج	The tower on the roof is a length of pipe.
9	neighbour	noun	a person who lives in the next house or flat	جار	A neighbour put it up in an afternoon.
10	roof	noun	the top of a building, above the highest floor	سطح البناية	There is a second antenna on the roof opposite.
11	afford	verb	to have enough money to pay for something	يستطيع تحمّل تكلفته	No single family could afford the line on its own.
12	apply	verb	to ask officially for a place, a job or money	يتقدّم بطلب	If she is not accepted, she will apply again in the spring.
13	scholarship	noun	money given to a student so that she can study	منحة دراسية	An exchange place with a small scholarship attached.
14	requirement	noun	something you must have or reach before you are allowed in	شرط	A language requirement she is four months from meeting.

2.2 Synonyms and opposites

WORD	SYNONYM	OPPOSITE
reliable	dependable, steady	unreliable

WORD	SYNONYM	OPPOSITE
afford	be able to pay for	be too expensive for
apply	put in a request	withdraw
relay	pass on, forward	hold back
latency	delay, lag	an instant reply
requirement	condition, must-have	an option
share	use together	keep to yourself
fail	stop working	hold up

2.3 Expressions to learn

EXPRESSION	WHAT IT REALLY MEANS
hangs off it	depends completely on it
a second way in	another route to the same place when the first fails
within a minute	very quickly indeed
either way	whichever of the two things happens
plan around something	arrange everything else to fit a thing you cannot change
turn a wish into an excuse	use what you lack as a reason to stop trying
four months away from	needing four more months to reach

2.4 Vocabulary practice

A. Write the opposite:

1. reliable → _____
2. afford → _____
3. apply → _____
4. share → _____
5. latency → _____

B. Which word is different? Say why:

1. antenna — tower — roof — scholarship
2. uplink — mesh — relay — requirement
3. latency — signal — bandwidth — neighbour

C. Say it in your own words:

1. What is latency, and when do you notice it?
2. What is a requirement? Name one you are working towards.

04 · Grammar — the first and second conditional

Come back to: the future with will and going to

Lesson 6 taught the two futures: going to for a decision already made, will for a decision made as you speak, and for an opinion. Two lines to remind you:

SHE IS GOING TO APPLY IN THE SPRING.	IT IS DECIDED
I think she will get in.	it is an opinion

New this time: after when, as soon as, before, after and until, English uses the present simple for future time.

This is the rule that the whole of today's grammar rests on, so it comes first:

I will send it when the power comes on. ✓
I will send it when the power will come on. ✗
She will apply again after she finishes the course. ✓
Wait until the latency drops, and then upload it. ✓

The future is already marked once, in the main clause, by will. English does not mark it twice. The time clause looks present and means future.

TIME CLAUSE — PRESENT SIMPLE	MAIN CLAUSE — *WILL*
When the class starts,	she will turn the video off.
As soon as the uplink comes back,	the lesson will continue.
Before she sends anything large,	she will tell the others.
Until the storm passes,	nobody will climb to the roof.

Quick practice. Put the verb in the right form.

1. I will call you when the power _____ (come) on.
2. She will apply again after she _____ (finish) the exam.
3. We will wait until the latency _____ (drop).
4. As soon as the slides _____ (load), the class _____ (begin).

A conditional sentence has two halves: the if-clause, which sets a condition, and the main clause, which says what follows. The order does not matter — If the uplink fails, nothing works and Nothing works if the uplink fails are the same sentence. Put a comma in only when the if-clause comes first.

Today there are two of them, and the difference between them is not time. It is how likely the speaker thinks it is.

3.1 The first conditional: real, and possible

if + present simple , will + verb

Use it for a real possibility in the future — something that may well happen:

IF-CLAUSE	MAIN CLAUSE
If the class fails on Monday,	she will read the slides.
If she is accepted,	she will go for one semester.
If it comes down in the storm,	they will put it up again.

Notice that the if-clause follows exactly the rule you have just revised: it is present in form and future in meaning. If the uplink will fail is wrong for the same reason when the power will come on is wrong.

You can replace will with another modal when the meaning needs it:

If the line is slow, the video may stop.
If you need to send something large, you should say so first.
If the latency drops, we can start.

3.2 The second conditional: unreal, or unlikely

if + past simple , would + verb

Use it for something that is not true now, or that you think will not happen. The past tense here is not past time — it is distance from reality:

IF-CLAUSE	MAIN CLAUSE
If she had a reliable fifty megabits,	she would stop planning around it.
If I lived nearer the college,	I would walk.
If they knew which hour it was,	they would plan the week properly.

She does not have fifty megabits. That is the whole point of the sentence. The past tense is what tells you so.

With be, use were for every person in careful written English:

If I were you, I would apply.
If the line were faster, she would not need Sunday night.

(If I was you is common in speech and is not wrong there. Write were.)

would becomes could for ability and might for a weaker guess: If she had the money, she could buy a better antenna.

3.3 First or second? The test — and it is not about time

	FIRST	SECOND
The speaker thinks	it may well happen	it is not true, or will not happen
If-clause	present simple	past simple
Main clause	will	would
Example	If she is accepted, she will go.	If she had a faster line, she would stop planning.

Both sentences above are about the future. The tense does not tell you when; it tells you how real the speaker thinks it is. Applying is real — she has sent the form. Fifty megabits is not.

3.4 unless = if … not

unless replaces an if-clause that is negative, and then the clause itself turns positive:

WITH *IF … NOT*	WITH *UNLESS*
If the uplink does not come back, the class is over.	Unless the uplink comes back, the class is over.
If you do not tell them first, they will be annoyed.	Unless you tell them first, they will be annoyed.

Two negatives is the mistake to watch for: unless the uplink does not come back says the opposite of what you mean.

3.5 Negative and question

	FIRST	SECOND
Negative	If it does not load, she will not wait.	If she did not have the recordings, she would not cope.
Question	What will you do if it fails?	What would you do if you had a faster line?

3.6 Grammar practice

A. First conditional. Put both verbs in the right form:

1. If the uplink _____ (fail), the class _____ (be) over.
2. If she _____ (be) accepted, she _____ (go) for one semester.
3. If two people _____ (ignore) the rule, everyone _____ (know).
4. She _____ (send) her questions as messages if the lesson _____ (not happen).

B. Second conditional. Put both verbs in the right form:

1. If she _____ (have) a faster line, she _____ (stop) planning around it.
2. If I _____ (be) you, I _____ (apply) this year.
3. If they _____ (know) when the power was coming, they _____ (not need) a plan.
4. What _____ you _____ (do) if the tower _____ (come) down tonight?

C. First or second? Choose, and say why:

1. If it rains tomorrow, we (will stay / would stay) inside.
2. If I (am / were) rich, I (will buy / would buy) everyone a line.
3. If the slides (load / loaded) in time, the class (will start / would start) at eight.
4. If she (does not get / did not get) the place, she (will apply / would apply) again.

D. Rewrite with unless:

1. If the uplink does not come back, the class is over.
2. If you do not tell them first, they will be annoyed.

E. Come back to — when, before, until:

1. I will upload it when the latency _____ (drop).
2. She will not apply until she _____ (pass) the exam.
3. Before she _____ (send) anything large, she will tell the others.

05 · The contracted 'd, and the weak if-clause

3.7 The contracted 'd, and the weak if-clause (listen to `05-would-and-if.mp3`)

The second conditional has two words doing all the work — if and would — and in speech both of them nearly disappear.

1. would becomes 'd, which is one sound: **/d/**.

WRITTEN IN FULL	WHAT YOU HEAR
I would stop.	/aɪd ˈstɒp/
She would go.	/ʃid ˈgəʊ/
They would put it up again.	/ðeɪd ˈpʊt ɪt ʌp əˈgen/
We would not wait.	/wi ˈwʊdnt ˈweɪt/

Note the last line: the negative keeps its full form, wouldn't /ˈwʊdnt/. As with can and can't, the negative is the loud one.

2. 'd is also had. The verb after it tells you which.

This is the one that confuses people, and the rule is simple:

YOU HEAR	NEXT WORD IS	SO *'D* MEANS	FULL SENTENCE
/ʃid ˈgəʊ/	go — a bare verb	would	She would go.
/ʃid ˈgɒn/	gone — a past participle	had	She had gone.

'd + bare verb = would. 'd + past participle = had. Nothing else can happen, so the verb after it always decides.

3. The if-clause is weak and runs together.

If is almost never stressed. It reduces to /əf/ and glues itself to what follows:

WRITTEN	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HEAR
If I had a faster line	/əf aɪ ˈhæd ə ˈfɑːstə ˈlaɪn/
If she is accepted	/əf ʃiz əkˈseptɪd/
If it comes down	/əf ɪt ˈkʌmz ˈdaʊn/

And the whole if-clause is said on a rising tone, which is what tells the listener that the sentence has not finished yet. The main clause falls. Copy the tune, not only the words: if you let the if-clause fall, people will think you have stopped speaking and will answer you.

In the audio you hear each line twice, and then a test: say whether the 'd you hear is would or had.

06 · Comprehension — a full TOEFL set of ten

Part A — Multiple choice

> This is a full set of ten, the size of a real TOEFL reading set.

1. (Factual) How many families share the line?

   A. Two.
   B. Four.
   C. Seven.
   D. Thirty.

2. (Factual) When does Aya download the slides?

   A. On Monday at eight.
   B. On Sunday night.
   C. During the class.
   D. Whenever the teacher sends them.

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, all of the following happen when the line is only slow EXCEPT

   A. the video stops.
   B. the voice survives.
   C. the class carries on.
   D. the lesson ends for everybody.

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "stutter" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. keep stopping and starting.
   B. become louder.
   C. disconnect completely.
   D. cost more.

5. (Reference) In the sentence, there is simply nothing to pass on, the words "nothing to pass on" refer to

   A. no antenna.
   B. no neighbours.
   C. no signal.
   D. no electricity.

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that Aya

   A. expects the exchange application to fail.
   B. treats the connection as a condition to work around rather than a reason to stop.

C. would rather study alone than in an online class.

D. plans to move to a street with a better line.

7. (Sentence insertion) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> Planning for the bad evening costs very little on a good one.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph) Why does the writer describe what Aya would do with a faster line?

A. To show that she is not satisfied with her neighbours.

B. To explain how a mesh network is built.

C. To show that she separates what she cannot change from what she can.

D. To argue that fifty megabits should be available to everyone.

9. (Purpose of the whole passage) What is the writer's main purpose in the whole passage?

A. To explain the technology of mesh networks.

B. To describe the difficulty of applying to a university abroad.

C. To show how one student works, and plans, around a connection that seven families share.

D. To persuade neighbours to agree rules about large uploads.

10. (The writer's attitude) Which word best describes the writer's attitude towards Aya?

A. Pitying.

B. Doubtful.

C. Amused.

D. Respectful.

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> uplink · mesh · latency · reliable · antenna · tower · scholarship · requirement · relay

1. Seven families share one _____.
2. In a _____, every point passes the signal on to the next.
3. The _____ on the roof is a length of pipe and two brackets.
4. She downloads the slides when the _____ is low.
5. The rules are what make a shared line _____.
6. The exchange place has a small _____ attached to it.

7. There is a language _____ she is four months from meeting.

Part D — Summary

Write the story in two sentences only. Use a first conditional once and a second conditional once.

> Sentence 1 — what will happen if the uplink fails on a Monday: _____ Sentence 2 — what Aya would do if she had a faster line: _____

07 · True / false

Part B — True / False

Write T or F. If it is false, write the correct sentence.

1. Each family in the street has its own line. ____
2. If the line is only slow, the voice usually survives. ____
3. Aya keeps the last four weeks of recordings on her laptop. ____
4. Nobody in the street sends anything large between seven and ten. ____
5. Aya says a faster line would let her stop planning around the connection. ____
6. If she is not accepted, she will give up and apply somewhere else. ____

08 · Speaking

5.1 Speaking (record each answer, 45 seconds)

1. Tell the story of the shared line in your own words. Use if at least three times.
2. What will you do if your connection fails during your next class? Use the first conditional.
3. If you could change one thing about where you study, what would it be, and what would change as a result?

Useful sentence starters:

If ____ happens, I will ____.

If I had ____, I would ____.

Unless ____, we will ____.

I will ____ as soon as ____.

If I were you, I'd ____.

09 · Writing — If the Connection Failed Tonight

5.2 Writing — "If the Connection Failed Tonight" (14–16 sentences)

Model answer (copy the shape, change the words):

> Our building shares one line with the two beside it, and everything we do depends on it. If the uplink fails, nobody has a second way in, so I have a plan for both kinds of evening. I download everything I will need on Sunday, when the latency is low and nobody is sending anything large. If my class goes down on Monday, I will read the slides I already have and send my questions as messages. If it does not go down, I have lost twenty quiet minutes and nothing else. We keep one rule in the group, and it is enough: tell the others before you send something big. If two people ignore it on the same night, everybody knows within a minute. People sometimes ask me what I would do with a faster connection. If I had one, I would stop planning around it and put that hour into the work itself, and I would stop apologising at the start of every call. If I were honest, though, the plan is not only about the line. I will keep making it after the line improves, because a week with a plan is steadier than a week without one. As soon as I pass the language test I will send the application, and if it is refused I will send it again in the spring.

Checklist before you send it:

- [ ] I used the first conditional at least four times, with present simple + will.
- [ ] I used the second conditional at least twice, with past simple + would.
- [ ] I used if I were, not if I was, in writing.
- [ ] I used unless, or as soon as / when with a present simple, at least once.
- [ ] I put a comma after the if-clause only when it came first.
- [ ] I used at least 5 new words from Session 2.
- [ ] I used at least 2 words from Lesson 6 or Lesson 7.
- [ ] My text has 14–16 sentences.

10 · Review

6.1 Listen again (no text)

1. What happens to the whole street if the uplink fails?
2. Why does Aya say she is careful about what she would do with a faster line?

6.2 Mini-quiz (12 marks)

1. The first conditional is if + ____ , ____ + verb. _____
2. The second conditional is if + ____ , ____ + verb. _____
3. Does the past tense in the second conditional mean past time? What does it mean? _____
4. Unless means the same as _____
5. After when, until and as soon as, which tense do you use for future time? _____
6. In she'd gone, does the 'd mean would or had? How do you know? _____
7. The opposite of reliable is _____
8. The delay between sending something and it arriving is _____
9. Write a first conditional about tomorrow.
10. Write a second conditional beginning If I had.
11. Write one sentence with requirement.
12. Tell the story of the passage in two sentences, from memory.

6.3 Lesson 8 self-report

QUESTION	ANSWER
Minutes studied this week	
Hardest part (listening / reading / vocabulary / grammar / speaking / writing)	
Conditional sentences I can now make without thinking	
Words from Lesson 6 I have forgotten	
One thing I want to repeat next week	

11 · Answer key and teacher notes

Listening: L1 — from a box on the third floor, up to an antenna on the roof and across to a second antenna on the roof opposite · L2 — the lesson is over for all thirty students, because nobody has a second way in · L3 — she downloads the slides, because the line is quiet and the latency is low · L4 — an exchange place at a university in Spain, with a small scholarship

Part A (MCQ): 1-C · 2-B · 3-D · 4-A · 5-C · 6-B · 7-B · 8-C · 9-C · 10-D

Why 7 is [B]: the sentence weighs the cost of preparing against the benefit, and only the paragraph after [B] does that — Sunday's download, the kept recordings, and the closing line that she has lost nothing but twenty minutes of a quiet Sunday. The paragraph after [A] explains the mesh, after [C] is the faster line she does not have, after [D]** the application.

Why 8 is C**: the paragraph opens by saying she is careful about the wish, because a wish is easy to turn into an excuse. The point is not the fifty megabits; it is the line she draws between what she cannot change and what she can.

Why 9 is C**: the technology is explained only as far as the story needs, the application is one paragraph of seven, and the rules about large uploads are reported, not argued for. The passage follows one person working around a shared constraint.

Why 10 is D, respectful: A is the trap. Pitying would be a reasonable guess from the subject matter, and it is wrong — pity would dwell on what is missing. This writer dwells on what is done: the plan, the rules, the second antenna, the tower put up twice. The one sentence that could invite pity, about apologising at the start of every call, is given as something she intends to stop, not as something to feel sorry about. Attitude questions reward reading the selection of detail**, not the subject.

Part B (True/False):

1. F — Seven families share one uplink through a mesh.
2. T
3. T
4. T
5. T
6. F — She will apply again in the spring.

Part C (Fill in the blanks): 1. uplink · 2. mesh · 3. tower · 4. latency · 5. reliable · 6. scholarship · 7. requirement (Extra words: antenna, relay)

2.4 A (Opposites): 1. unreliable · 2. be too expensive for · 3. withdraw · 4. keep to yourself · 5. an instant reply

2.4 B (Odd one out): 1. scholarship (the others are on or above a building) · 2. requirement (the others are parts of a network) · 3. neighbour (the others are properties of a connection)

Come back to (time clauses): 1. comes · 2. finishes · 3. drops · 4. load … will begin

3.6 A (first conditional): 1. fails … will be · 2. is … will go · 3. ignore … will know · 4. will send … does not happen

3.6 B (second conditional): 1. had … would stop · 2. were … would apply · 3. knew … would not need · 4. would … do … came

3.6 C (first or second, and why):

1. will stay — rain tomorrow is a real possibility
2. were … would buy — she is not rich; the past tense marks it as unreal
3. load … will start — a real possibility this evening
4. does not get … will apply — she may well not get it; it is real either way

3.6 D (unless): 1. Unless the uplink comes back, the class is over. · 2. Unless you tell them first, they will be annoyed.

3.6 E (time clauses): 1. drops · 2. passes · 3. sends

Mini-quiz: 1. present simple, will · 2. past simple, would · 3. No — it means distance from reality: the thing is not true, or is not expected · 4. if … not · 5. the present simple · 6. had, because gone is a past participle; 'd + bare verb is would, 'd + past participle is had · 7. unreliable · 8. latency · 9–12. teacher judgement

Teacher Notes

What changed from Lesson 7, and what deliberately did not. 516 words, against 510 in Lesson 7 and 504 in Lesson 6 — three lessons at one length, which was the point of the plateau. Over these three weeks the difficulty has moved entirely into the grammar and the vocabulary: the future, then the modals, now the conditionals, with the technical density climbing each time. The question set has not changed since Lesson 5 and will not change again.

The one real difficulty. Not the forms, which are two patterns on a card. It is understanding that the past tense in the second conditional is not past time. Arabic does not use a past form to mark unreality, so if she had a faster line reads to her as a sentence about last year. Section 3.3 is the one to work: both example sentences are about the future, and the only thing the tense tells you is how real the speaker thinks it is. Ask her, for each sentence in 3.6 C, does the speaker think this will happen? — the answer to that chooses the tense.

The rule everything rests on. The Come back to section is deliberately placed before the conditionals rather than after. I will call you when the power comes on and if the power comes on, I will call you are the same rule: the future is marked once, in the main clause, and the subordinate clause stays present. A student who has that rule finds the first conditional almost automatic; a student who has not will write if the uplink will fail for a year. Teach it first even if you run out of time for 3.5.

Why the pronunciation part is the one to protect. The whole second conditional hangs on one consonant, and that consonant is ambiguous: 'd is would and 'd is had. The test is mechanical — a bare verb after it means would, a past participle means had — and once she has it, a large amount of spoken English stops being a guess. The weak if and the rising tune matter nearly as much: if she lets the if-clause fall, people will answer before she has finished the sentence.

Why this story, and a note on it. The passage touches her own situation — a shared line, a class that depends on it, an exchange application with a language requirement. That is on purpose, and so is the

distance: the student in it is somebody else, the detail is practical rather than personal, and nothing in it is there to be felt sorry about. The conditionals need a real constraint to be about, because a conditional sentence is how a person reasons about what is and is not within reach, and that is exactly what this passage is doing.

Success criteria for Lesson 8. The student should be able to:

- answer L1–L4 correctly on the second hearing;
- hear she'd gone and she'd go and say which is which, and why;
- build both conditionals and choose between them for a reason she can state;
- use the present simple after if, when, until, as soon as and before;
- write if I were, not if I was;
- rewrite an if … not sentence with unless;
- use 10 of the 14 key words in her own sentence;
- write 14 sentences with fewer than 4 conditional errors.

If it is too easy: add the third conditional (if she had applied, she would have gone) and the mixed conditional, both of which follow naturally from the 'd work in part 05. If it is too hard: teach the first conditional alone this week, with the time-clause rule, and leave the second for a week of its own. The second conditional is the harder idea by a long way, and splitting them costs nothing.

A note on spaced recall. `03-vocabulary.mp3` ends with five Lesson 6 words — download, cloud, schedule, laptop, socket. Lesson 7 recalled Lesson 5, so the two-lesson gap holds. Lesson 7's words are due back in Lesson 9.

Where the course is now. Eight lessons, one progress test, a complete TOEFL question set and eight tenses or structures, all spiralled at least twice. The length has been flat for three lessons, which means the next decision is whether Lesson 9 lets it rise again or holds it a fourth time — that is a question about her, not about the material, and the self-report at 6.3 is where the answer should come from. A second progress test, covering Lessons 4 to 8, would fit naturally before Lesson 9.